

7.1 The nucleus

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- identify particles inside the nucleus
- discuss the historical origins of the particles of the nucleus
- define and discuss isotope of an atom
- describe the relationships between nuclear mass and binding energy of isotopes;
- calculate binding energy of the nucleus of different isotopes;
- identify the nuclear forces, (strong nuclear force, weak nuclear force)

7.2 Radioactivity

By the end of this section you should be to:

- define the terms radio-activity, and distinguish between the three types of emissions, alpha radiation, beta- radiation and gamma- radiation
- recognize and discuss dangers of ionizing radiation;
- discuss radioactive dating and radiation detectors;
- identify radioactive sources in the school, home, and workplace and
- recommend protective measures to the school community.

7.3 Use of nuclear radiation

By the end of this section you should be able to:

- investigate the benefits and hazards (nuclear waste) of nuclear energy production;
- discuss and appreciate the application of nuclear medicine

7.4 Nuclear Reaction and Energy Production

By the end of this section you should be able to:

- distinguish between the two types of nuclear reaction;
- appreciate the sun as a big nuclear reactor.
- discuss the use (energy production, production of important isotopes, etc.)
- and misuse (nuclear bomb) of artificial nuclear reaction.

7.5 Safety Rules Against Hazards of Nuclear Radiation

By the end of this section you should be able to:

- implement safety rules against hazards of nuclear radiation